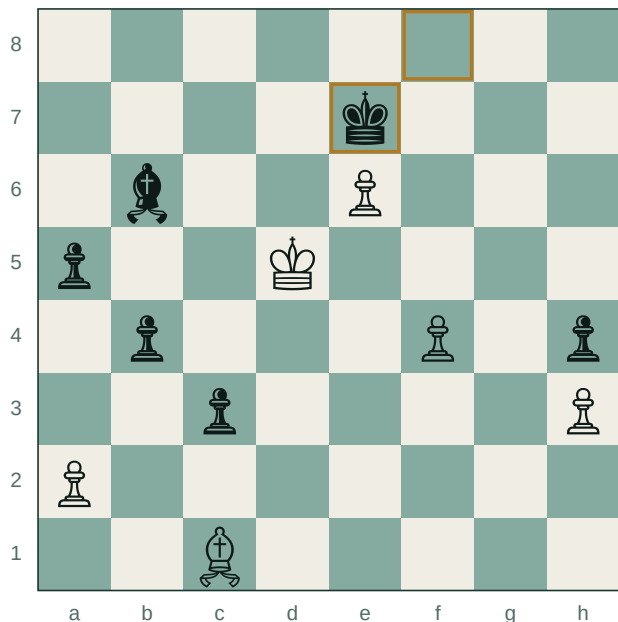


# Bishop-ending decisions: White, move 40

Bishop-ending decisions

White to move



Previous move: 39...Ke7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**40. f5 Bd8 41. Bg5+ Ke8 42. f6 Bxf6 43. Bxf6**

**40.f5** The pawn moves from f4 to f5. Recorded reply: **40...Bd8**.

**41.Bg5+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **41...Ke8**.

**42.f6** The pawn moves from f5 to f6. Recorded reply: **42...Bxf6**.

**43.Bxf6** The bishop captures the bishop on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

## HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on e7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b6. Check for tactical protection.